

WORKBOOK
MODULE 1

Transition OS

Work out whether you are actually leaving, and what you are protecting if you are.

THE EIGHT STOPS

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Start	Ground	Explore	Connect	Translate	Test	Leap	After
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Name

Started on

Print it, or type straight into it.

What's in here

Your starting line	What an hour of your work pays now, and the number the next job has to clear	☐
Bad week, or time to go	Answer the same thing in week 1, 6 and 12 so one bad Tuesday does not decide it	☐
Why leaving isn't a wasted degree	Why the years and the debt already spent are not a reason to stay	☐
Your why, in writing	What you actually want to leave, so you know what to look for in the next job	☐
What you'll miss	What you give up by leaving, and which parts you can keep anyway	☐
Telling the first person	Say it out loud to one person, and plan exactly what you'll say first	☐
Kept private	Six settings to change before anyone at work can guess, and your staff-room sentence	☐

The informational interview sheet, the interview page and the offer page come with the full program.

Do the lesson on screen first. It does the maths, the sorting and the ranking, and it keeps your answers.

Write badly. Fragments, half-sentences, a list. If you catch yourself drafting sentences, you have switched into work mode.

LESSON 0.2 · THE MONEY PAGE

Your starting line

What an hour of your work pays now, and the number the next job has to clear. The lesson does the arithmetic; write the answers here.

What an hour pays now

Salary now Gross, before tax	
Hours in a real week Including the evenings and the Sunday notes	
Weeks worked a year A school year is about 39	
Your real hourly rate Salary divided by hours times weeks. The lesson shows it, and what the same salary pays at forty hours	

The number the next job has to clear

Monthly expenses The real month, not the good one	
Tax you assume Federal, state and the 7.65% payroll share. Your guess, as a percentage	
The annual floor Expenses times twelve, grossed up for the tax. Below this you decline	
The date When you want to be somewhere else. A month and a year	

LESSON 0.2 · THE TRADES

What you would trade to get there

Tick the ones that are genuinely on the table. The lesson uses these to rule paths in and out.

- ☐ Move city or state
- ☐ Take a pay dip for the first year
- ☐ Go without employer benefits for a while
- ☐ Commute again
- ☐ Give up remote work
- ☐ Work in an office with other people every day

The one you ticked that surprised you, and why it is on the table now when it was not a year ago.

WEEKS 1, 6 AND 12

Bad week, or time to go

Answer these in week 1, then again in week 6 and week 12. One bad Tuesday should not be the thing that decides it.

	Week 1	Week 6	Week 12
Date			
The stage you are in			
Bad workplace, bad fit, or bad season			
The path you would name today			
Your pay floor			

Where you are going, in one sentence. Write a new one each time rather than editing the old one.

Three sentences by week twelve. The first one is usually about leaving and the last one usually is not.

MODULE 1 • SUNK COST

Why leaving isn't a wasted degree

The years and the debt are already spent either way. This is where you stop counting them as a reason to stay.

Write it exactly as it sounds in your head. Not the reasonable version.

It usually starts with "after all that" or "I should be able to".

"I know it's the sunken cost fallacy but it's so hard to quit after putting so much time, money, and effort into this career." an SLP, r/slp

Who taught you that sentence? A supervisor, a cohort, a parent, yourself at twenty-four.

What would you say to a CF who said it to you, word for word?

People are consistently kinder to a hypothetical CF than to themselves. Use the kinder version.

MODULE 1 · THE CHECKPOINT

Your why, in writing

What you want to leave, in your own words, so you know what you are looking for in the next job.

Everything you want to leave. Names, days, specific meetings, the thing you have never said out loud. Do not soften it.

Nobody reads this.

Read it back, and mark the three that would still be true in a different building.

Those three are about the work. Everything else is about this job, and that is a different problem with a faster fix.

MODULE 1 · WHAT YOU KEEP

What you'll miss

Name it now. The people who skip this are the ones who end up going back.

Finish the sentence: I will miss being the person who ...

"I've taken a long time to grieve the loss of who I was in my previous role." a comment on a former SLP's essay about leaving

Which part of that goes with you into any job? A moment, a person, a session. Be specific.

Which part only exists in a clinic, and what will you do about that outside work?

MODULE 1 • LESSON 7

Telling the first person

Say it out loud to one person. Plan who, when, and what you will say.

Who Not a colleague, if you can avoid it	
When A date, not "soon"	
What you plan to say One sentence	

What you actually said, and what they said back.

Fill this in afterwards. People are almost always less surprised than you expect them to be.

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What changed for you in the hour after.

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MODULE 1 · LESSON 7, BEFORE YOU SAY IT

Kept private

Six settings and habits from lesson 1.7, so the search stays yours until you decide otherwise. Tick them as you do them.

- ☐ LinkedIn: “Share profile updates with your network” is off
- ☐ LinkedIn: Open to Work is set to recruiters only, not the banner
- ☐ Applications and job alerts go to a personal email, never the work one
- ☐ Nobody at your current job is listed as a reference
- ☐ You know your contract window or notice period, and the date it falls on
- ☐ The one sentence for the staff room is ready: “I’m looking at what else I could do with my SLP background.”

That sentence in your own words, the way you would actually say it at the copier.

If they ask what: “I don’t know yet. I’m finding out.” True, and it ends the conversation on your terms.